Nikhil Salunke

AGM & GENAI DEVELOPER, IT ANALYTICS

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SKILLS

- GenAI Chatbots, Agentic AI , RAG, LLM
- LLMOps, Prompt-Engineering
- LLM Fine Tuning & Optimization
- Solutioning Scalable Architecture
- Cloud Computing, Model Deployments
- Python, SQL, Bash Scripting
- Data Lake, Neo4J, Graph Analytics
- Data Engineering & Analytics
- Team & Project management
- Data Science, Machine Learning
- Business Negotiation

ACADEMICS

MBA in Digital Telecom Management:

Tenure: 2021-2023
University: Symbiosis
CGPA: 8.00

B. Tech in Electronics & Telecom

Tenure: 2016-2019
University: V.J.T.I (Mumbai)
CGPA: 8.29

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Oracle Cloud Infrastructure AI Certified Foundations Associate**
- AWS Cloud Foundations
- Agile Project Management
- Product Management

TOOLS & LANGUAGES

- **Languages**: Python, SQL, Bash
- **Frameworks & Libraries:** LangChain, LangGraph, Agentic AI, vLLM
- **Cloud & Infra**: AWS, OCI, Data Lake
- **Dev Tools:** GitHub, SSH, Colab.

PROFILE SUMMARY

AGM – IT Analytics & AI Product Leader specializing in the strategic deployment of **Agentic AI, LLMs, and RAG architectures**. Currently spearheading GenAI initiatives at **Vodafone Idea**, delivering high-impact systems—including **Agentic CV Screeners** and **Enterprise Chatbots**—that achieve **90% OpEx reduction**. Expert in leading the end-to-end product lifecycle, from **stakeholder management** and **BRD authorship** to scalable deployment on **AWS/OCI**. Technical architect proficient in **Python, SQL, LangChain, LangGraph, and vLLM**, with a focus on **Local LLM optimization (Mistral)** and **high-concurrency serving**. **OCI GenAI Certified** leader with an **MBA (Systems) & B.Tech (Electronics & Telecom)**, combining technical mastery in **Open-Source AI** with the strategic vision to translate complex business needs into production-ready, secure enterprise intelligence.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AGM – IT ANALYTICS | VODAFONE IDEA LTD (VI) | *JUL 2023 – PRESENT*

Lead the end-to-end AI product lifecycle, delivering scalable, open-source-first GenAI solutions. Manage cross-functional teams to automate complex business processes and reduce OpEx through architectural innovation.

Key Projects:

AGENTIC HR INTELLIGENCE & CV SCREENER | LEAD DEVELOPER & PM

- **Architected an Agentic RAG system** using **LangGraph, Mistral-7B** (4-bit quantized), and **vLLM** on AWS EC2, enabling HR to interactively query candidate profiles via a custom chatbot.
- Engineered **high-precision retrieval** using ElasticSearch Vector DB and a **custom reranker**, **outperforming standard cross-encoders** to provide granular match-percentage scores.
- **Lead SDLC & Product Strategy**: **Authored BRDs/HLDs and managed a cross-functional team** (React frontend/Python backend) to deliver a **secure, local LLM solution**. Designed the project flow In AGILE based milestone oriented project delivery plan.
- **Infrastructure Optimization**: Integrated **NVIDIA A10 GPU** acceleration and **PII masking for data security**; currently refactoring for **CPU-based inference** to further minimize OpEx.

Quantifiable Impact: Compressed 10-day screening cycles into seconds and achieved a 90% reduction in licensing costs through open-source architectural efficiency.

HR ANALYTICS DASHBOARDS – RECRUITMENT & ATTRITION

- Developed HR dashboards to visualize recruitment pipelines (2024) and attrition trends (2023).
- Engineered backend data Ingestion/ data engineering and data models.
- Technology Stack: Hive, IBM DB2, Cognos BI.
- Enabled quicker insights and self-service reports for HR to have more accurate strategic decisions.

Impact: Reduced 7-day reporting cycles to automated self-serve analytics.
Awarded Certificate of Excellence for impact and innovation.

OTHER INITIATIVES: Developed multiple lightweight GenAI prototypes

Text-to-SQL Chatbot: Enabled users to query databases in natural language on LLM-powered Interface
Image Captioning Automation: Enabled users to identify if the SMS content & brand image is aligning.
Excel/CSV Analyzer Chatbot: Enabled users to ask anything about dataset in natural language
HR Policy Document Q&A Bot: Created a RAG-based chatbot to instantly answer employee queries from lengthy HR policy documents.
Email Summarizer and chatbot: Created a chatbot to summarize email and Identify key takeways and pending action Items from various stakeholders.

ASSOCIATE ENGINEER | L&T TECHNOLOGY SERVICES| AUG 2019 – AUG 2020

- Investigated and resolved modem crashes and stability issues in the 4G network stack.
- Handled service requests, integrated patch solutions, and maintained weekly RCA reports.
- Built an automation Python tool to compare config files across operators & builds
- Achievement: Ranked #1 in technical training performance across the L&T cohort.